

Sound



Did you know?

Some singers can sing a note so high and so loud that it will shatter glass!



Sound waves move outward through the air.

Skin vibrates, or shakes.

Warning sounds

Smoke detectors beep loudly if a fire starts.



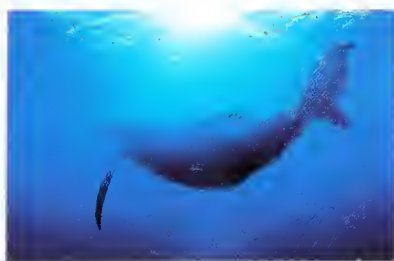
Alarm clocks ring to wake you in the morning.



Speed of sound



Light travels faster than sound. That is why you see lightning before you hear thunder.



Sound travels farther in water than in air. Whales can hear noise up to 60 miles (100 km) away.

The world is full of sounds. Some are useful, others are just annoying! But we hear them all in the same way.

Sound waves

All sounds are made by vibrations, which move the air and send out invisible sound waves to our ears.



Drum stick

Drum base

Noise levels

The loudness of a sound is measured in decibels.

Falling leaves are quiet. Their noise measures 20 decibels.



Talking to people measures 30 to 60 decibels.



Vacuum cleaners reach 60 to 80 decibels.



Jumbo jets are very loud, making 140 decibels of noise!

Musical sounds

Musical instruments make sounds in different ways.

A double bass makes sounds as its strings vibrate.



Recorders make sounds when air vibrates inside the hollow tube.

